

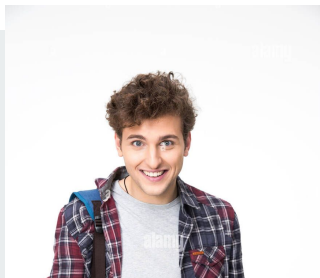


Personas

The best way to think about what your learners need to know is to develop a persona that includes the assumed characteristics of your intended audience.

Characteristics can include...

1. Previous knowledge
2. Motivation for taking the course
3. Comfort level or previous experience learning with the domain content



Kliment Volkov

Freshman
18 years old

Educational Overview

High school

Quote / Summary

Kliment is a first year undecided student, and coding has been something he has enjoyed for a long time. When it comes to math, he finds it always takes much longer than he expects to understand a concept, since he already has a good grasp on various coding languages he is unsure why math is necessary to develop his interest. As a non-native English speaker, he sometimes struggles with accurate phrases to express himself to his professors or TAs.

"When I write code I know exactly what I need to say! I hear math can help me write better code, but I can't see how these things connect."

Content Knowledge

- Proficient in English, native Russian speaker
- Familiar with C++ and Python, which he picked up for game development
- He enjoys coding in general, but he thinks he needs math to expand his skillset to the growing field of AI

Motivation for Taking Course

- To understand how math can improve code and how code can do math
- To decide if coding is just a fun hobby or if he wants to pursue a CS degree
- The course is a prerequisite for multiple majors he might choose

Engagement Strategies/Challenges

- Attends class regularly
- Office hours conflict with his work-study job
- Attends tutoring
- Is overwhelmed in group discussions



Anika Burgess

Pre-med student
19 years old

Educational Overview

Advanced placement Literature, Calculus, & Chemistry

Quote / Summary

Anika is a former high school mathlete who has developed a strong interest in infectious disease medicine, especially graduating high school during the pandemic. She will be taking this course to enhance her knowledge of organic chemistry and discover the role it plays in her career pursuits. She took AP Chemistry in high school and assumes it has prepared her for success in this course.

"I need an A in this course to improve my chances of scoring high on the MCAT and getting into Harvard Medical School!"

Content Knowledge

- AP Chemistry
- Completed several dual enrollment courses while in high school
- Interned in diagnostic lab over the summer

Motivation for Taking Course

- Thinks organic chemistry might have some relevance to drug discovery and vaccine design
- Organic Chemistry is mandatory for all Pre-Med majors
- Wants to be the next Kizzy!

Engagement Strategies

- Would like to find a study group similar to the one she experience at her private high school
- Attends office hours regularly
- Seeks out undergraduate research opportunities



First Last

Rank

Age

Major



Quote / Summary

Name is a [academic background]...

Name likes to...

"Quote.." [related to reason for the taking the course, including their expectations and hopes].



Content Knowledge

- (What is the previous knowledge the learner might have that is related to the course? (e.g., knowledge gained through education experience and working experience))
- (What is the previous knowledge the learner might lack but is expected to have?)



Motivation for Taking Course

- Motivator #1
- Motivator #2
- Motivator #3



Engagement Strategies

- (The content in the following brackets are for your reference, feel free to edit)
- (Proficient in using online learning platform)
- (Intend to view all modules in the course)
- (Would like to explore instructor's recommendations of external resources)
- (Will dedicate 3-4 hours a week for study)



First Last

Rank

Age

Major



Quote / Summary

Name is a [academic background]...

Name likes to...

"Quote.." [related to reason for the taking the course, including their expectations and hopes].



Content Knowledge

- (What is the previous knowledge the learner might have that is related to the course? (e.g., knowledge gained through education experience and working experience))
- (What is the previous knowledge the learner might lack but is expected to have?)



Motivation for Taking Course

- Motivator #1
- Motivator #2
- Motivator #3



Engagement Strategies

- (The content in the following brackets are for your reference, feel free to edit)
- (Proficient in using online learning platform)
- (Intend to view all modules in the course)
- (Would like to explore instructor's recommendations of external resources)
- (Will dedicate 3-4 hours a week for study)



Activity: **Create 2 Personas**

Learning Outcome: At the end of this activity instructors will have created 2 personas they can use to support their course redesign.

Directions:

1. ***Start with the aspirational persona. In your course teams, think about your perceived ideal student.***
 - a. Identify what type of previous experience or content knowledge they would they have
 - b. What motivates them to take the course or do well in the course
 - c. How would they engage in the course or expect to engage in the course.
 - d. Provide a summary of the student that may include the sentence starters provided.
 - e. Provide a quote that would be from the point of view of the persona that can help get to know this type of student better.
2. ***Complete a persona based on the data you received about your course this semester***
 - a. Utilize some of the data points Aminah discussed with you all to inform your persona.
 - b. This persona should represent a perspective of a student who typically receives a D, F or W in your course.
 - c. Complete all steps identified in 1a-1e.
3. ***We will discuss your personas after lunch.***